

they didn't even have to go to the work of hacking your email or computer to accomplish it.

Social engineering, like other cyber risks, can take numerous forms and is constantly growing. We'll go through what social engineering looks like today, attack types to be aware of, and red flags to look for in order to avoid becoming a victim.

What is Social Engineering?

The method of manipulating, influencing, or deceiving a victim in order to obtain control of a computer system or steal personal and financial information is known as social engineering. It employs psychological tricks to persuade users to make security mistakes or divulge critical information.



Social engineering attacks are carried out via a series of steps. To carry out the assault, a perpetrator first examines the intended victim to obtain relevant background information, such as potential avenues of entry and weak security mechanisms. The attacker then employs pretexting techniques like impersonation to earn the victim's trust and give stimuli for subsequent acts that violate security protocols, such as divulging sensitive information or granting access to crucial resources.

Typical steps in a social engineering attack

Social engineering, like most forms of deception, is based on false trust first and persuasion second. In general, a successful social engineering attack follows four steps: